

Sony CRX85U CD-RW/DVD-ROM combi drive

Write said Fred!

The Sony CRX85U combi drive can write data on CD-RW at speeds of 20x and read DVDs at a maximum speed of 8x. The drive has support for the USB 2.0 interface and comes bundled with a rather unusual interface cable—basically a USB to ATAPI conversion cable. The drive is powered by an external power source, which makes it cumbersome to carry around. The drive is very slim and light, and the lid can be opened only when it is powered. In an un-powered state, the lid can be opened by using the manual eject switch located underneath the drive.

The drive took 9 minutes 14 seconds to burn a 700 MB CD-R with assorted data. This is slower than an internal IDE 16x CD-Writer. It's equipped with an 8 MB buffer, which is sufficient to eliminate errors



while burning at speeds as high as 20x.

The CRX85U comes bundled with B's Recorder Gold that makes the task of burning CDs very easy, even for new users. The package also contains B's Clip for simple file copy operations along with VideoImpression and PhotoBase for video and image editing. Sony has also bundled Retrospect backup software, which lets you backup your hard disk data onto a CD.

SPECIFICATIONS

20x CD-R, 8x CD-RW, 8x DVD-ROM, 24x CD-ROM, 8 MB onboard buffer, USB 2.0

Sony CRX85U

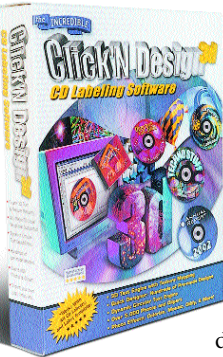
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 30,000
Contact: Rashi Peripherals P Ltd
Phone: 022-8260256/59
Fax: 022-8221012
E-mail: ho@rptechindia.com
Web site: www.sony.com

Click'N Design 3D

Design-er label

Click'N Design 3D is a comprehensive CD label and jewel case label designer. It allows you to create and design professional looking CD labels and jewel case labels with minimal effort. This application has built-in, ready-to-use images and you can create 3D text with different colour effects. You can also



add different effects such as Emboss and Oily to the 55 different images bundled in addition to custom images. An important functionality that is built into this software is its ability to create barcodes using different standards predefined

standards predefined

within the software—just type the text and the barcode will be generated automatically! The software has a very simple and intuitive interface, with self-explanatory icons. Click'N Design 3D is a good choice for CD authoring houses and software developers

Price: Rs 2,250
Contact: Microware Computer Services
Phone: 022-8729725
Fax no: 022-8727446
E-mail: sales@mwcdrom.com
Web site: www.stompinc.com

who create different CD/DVDs and other such storage media.

SPECIFICATIONS

System Requirements: Windows 95/98/Me/2000/XP, Pentium 200 MHz or faster processor, 32 MB RAM (64 MB recommended), 25 MB free disk space

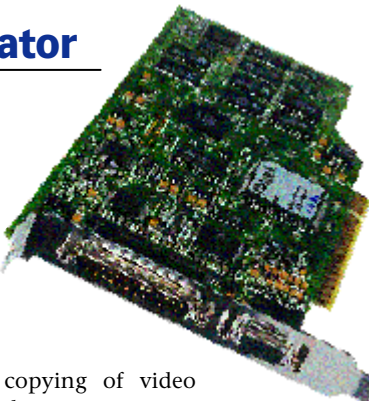
Click'N Design 3D B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

MONARCH FX Creator

The FX effect

The FX Creator is an audio-video mixer, developed in India by Monarch Video Vision. It works flawlessly and comes complete with both the hardware and software required for real time audio and video mixing. The package allows you to perform complete audio and video editing and mixing just like any electronic audio-video mixer. The software is fairly easy to operate and comes with a very informative demo that demonstrates the software's working. Surprisingly, these demos are in Hindi and are narrated well, with every aspect of the software explained in complete detail.

FX Creator comes with four video inputs (two each for composite video and S-Video), you also have four stereo audio mixers with one mike input and two stereo outputs for online audio mixers. It can output at a broadcast quality resolution of 720x576 with a two-channel digital timebase corrector that enables faithful



copying of video data.

FX Creator is extremely useful for videographers and post-production studios. It is rated to run on a system with a Pentium 133 MHz or higher processor, 128 MB RAM and a minimum of 10 GB hard drive space. We found this reference system slow for its applications but it ran well when we used a 1.5 GHz processor with 256 MB RAM. The product also comes with a one-year replacement warranty.

SPECIFICATIONS

4 video inputs, 4 channel stereo audio mixer, 2 graphic inputs, 2 video outputs, 2 channel digital video mixer with 2 full frame TBCs and 2 channel video processor for brightness, contrast and saturation

MONARCH FX Creator B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 78,000
Contact: Monarch Video Vision
Phone: 022-2619022/2705555
Fax: 022-2618706
E-mail: viren@bom2.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.monarchvision.com